SAMPLE

The Stargazing Dreamer

The Personality That Aims Past Its Reach on Purpose

Aiman Sterling

Free sample: Chapter 1

putrabooks.github.io

Buy the full book:

Gumroad

Chapter 1: The First Glance — the Stargazing Dreamer at a Party

The Telltale Manner

At the party, the tell is the plan three sizes too big — and the sky map's first finding is the stargazer's conversational gravity: every topic, however small, is drawn into orbit around the Aim. The kitchen renovation becomes the compound; the new job becomes the empire; the hobby becomes the festival, the tour, the school; and the room splits, as it always does, into the believers and the eye-rollers, and the Dreamer — the file notes this with real warmth — is happiest at the exact moment the realists wince, because the wince is the confirmation that the aim is high enough. The manner is bright, fast, and oddly calm: no anxiety about the impossible, no apology for the scale; the horizon recited like a grocery list, the moon mentioned like a suburb. And the small tell that divides the genuine article from the mere boaster: the Dreamer believes it — has believed it since childhood, alone, and the belief survived decades of nothing; the plan is not a performance for the room. It is the residence. The guest is at the party physically; the rest of them is living somewhere out past the marker buoys, and has been since the age of nine.

The Backstory Signature

The signature in the past is smallness answered with stars — and the file assembles the founding carefully, because it is the gentlest in this catalog. The smallness was real: the small town or the cramped flat, the narrow means, the narrow expectations — the house's whole sentence, spoken or ambient: people like us don't. And the child, reading the smallness the way every child on this shelf reads their environment, made the opposite move: looked up. The telescope, the library card, the one adult who pointed — the teacher who said "why not you," the grandfather with the star charts, the book that opened like a roof; and the discovery that defines the type, made somewhere around ten: the only real failure is aiming too low — because the small aims were already taken, already lived, already proven hollow by the adults around; and the impossible aim, examined, was the only honest escape route from a life the house had already furnished. The child aimed past the reach on purpose, and the aiming worked: the identity arrived immediately — I am the one who will — and the smallness, still there, stopped mattering, because the child no longer lived in the small room. The child lived in the gap.

The Childhood Album

Open the album and the photos have sky in them: the kid on the roof with the binoculars; the kid at the library table with the stack of books about far things; the

bedroom wall — the file finds one in nearly every case, described with startling consistency — covered in the Aim: the cutouts, the traced route, the countdown. The recurring figure is the child pointing up — at the sky, at the map, at the stage, at the poster of the far thing — and the album's most telling feature is the absence of arrival: no photos of small finished things, no record of the ordinary milestones celebrated on their own merits — the certificate unframed, the modest win unphotographed — because the lens of this childhood only opened for the Aim. And the margin note, written gently, because it is the whole book: the album documents a child who escaped magnificently — and never once came back down; every photo after the founding looks toward, and there is not one that simply looks at, at the room, the day, the small warm present the child was aiming out of, which was, the file notes, the only thing in the whole album that was actually real at the time.

The Type at a Glance

Energy: Bright, fast, and horizon-gated — the wattage is highest at maximum distance from the present: the five-year plan hums, the ten-year plan sings, and this afternoon's task list is a form of death; the energy of a system designed to run on gap.

Ambition: Beyond the wingspan, by policy — the target sits past the reach, moves outward as the reach grows, and is never lowered; the ambition's shape is a direction, not a summit: the Dreamer does not want to arrive; the Dreamer wants to aim.

Vanity structure: The height of the aim — the quiet, total pride in never having shrunk; and beneath it the founding's arithmetic: I am the one who aims high; lowering is dying — which is also the trap, because the pride is attached to the aiming rather than the walking, and one of them has produced nothing.

Loyalty: Directed at the Aim first, and the people who honor it second — the Dreamer keeps faith with the believers: the teacher, the grandmother, the friend who never winced; and the sky map notes the stargazer's sharpest wound: being humored — the pat-on-the-head tolerance of the aim, which this constitution experiences as the smallness, aimed at them again.

Weakness: The declined present — this type cannot inhabit today: the attainable is contempt's subject, the finished small thing is evidence of small living, and "settling" is the founding's dirty word; and the blindness riding with it: the Dreamer has no idea that the present is not the enemy of the aim — it is the only place the aim could ever have been built.

Unspoken need: To be believed — taken seriously about the star, by someone whose respect matters, without the wince and without the pedestal; and beneath that, the need the first comet never let the stargazer locate: to find out whether the self survives landing — whether the one who aims is lovable at ground level, in the small room, on an ordinary Tuesday, with no gap to live in and the star, at last, caught or dropped.

The Type in Five Situations

At a party: the plan three sizes too big, the realists wincing, the believers leaning in; the best conversation at the party and the least present person in the room — invited everywhere, at home nowhere near the furniture.

In a new job: overqualified and under-aimed by week two — the role handled easily, the horizon scanned immediately, the exit drafted by month three unless the organization offers a far thing; the employer's file reads the same every time: brilliant, restless, "not a fit" — and the truth underneath: the Dreamer was never applying for the job; the Dreamer was applying for the gap.

Under sudden pressure: calm — strangely, reliably calm; the file's honest entry: the impossible target normalizes crisis, because the type has lived at the edge of impossible since nine; the disaster that flattens others is, to this constitution, Tuesday on the route to the star — and the crew is steadied by the only person in the room who was never promised anything easy.

In a boring meeting: the vision nobody asked for — the safe plan expanded threefold, the realist agenda overridden by the horizon; the meeting is more alive afterward and completely unresourced, and the file notes the Dreamer's private verdict, never spoken: they are planning the year; I am planning the century.

On holiday: the big announcement at the family table — the new plan, the far school, the move, the venture; the aunts exchange the look; the grandmother asks a real question; and the family's warm verdict, gathered across decades: nothing ever comes of it — and we would not trade the way he tells it for anything that did — the family's realists paying, without knowing it, the aim's real wage: hope, delivered seasonally, in the small house the aim was built to escape.

Not to Be Confused With

Not the Triumphant Valkyrie, the personality that treats battle as sacrament — the confusion is instant, because both are ambitious, both are magnetic, and both make the realists wince. The hinge is the destination's meaning. The Valkyrie needs the victory: the summit reached, the flag planted, the self proven by arrival; the climb has a top, and the Valkyrie is on it. The Dreamer needs the aim: the star is not meant to be caught — catching it would end the identity — and the target moves outward as the reach grows; the sky map's sharpest line on the pair: the Valkyrie retires satisfied; the Dreamer retires mid-sentence, and both got exactly what they were built for, and only one of them has a shelf.

Not the Untamed Wanderer, the personality that keeps every option open — the confusion is subtler, because both are allergic to the settled present, and both are misfiled as "unrealistic." The hinge is the structure of the escape. The Wanderer flees commitment: no star, no fixed aim, every door left unlocked, the freedom itself as the residence; the wandering is lateral. The Dreamer is locked on one star, committed past all reason, the whole biography bent around a single fixed impossible point; the dreaming is longitudinal. Watch both in the same town at forty: the Wanderer is leaving again; the Dreamer is staying — and announcing the same Aim they

announced at twenty, at twenty-five, at thirty — the one committed to everything and the one committed to nothing, sharing only the one symptom: neither of them is here.

And the party sky map closes with the refined field check the star count has waited the whole this firmament to deploy, because the far aim defeats every ordinary instrument — the stargazer reads as magnetic at first contact and as airborne by the second hour, and the seam between them has never been measured — and the refined check is run not at the plans but at the return: ask about the mile, and time the descent. the skywatcher's log of a recorded wonder: the stargazer at thirty-nine, the aim certified at three decades — and the instrument is the ordinary question, deliberately pencilled: "how's the move going — the one to the studio?" And the star count's findings, shadowedacross the conversation: the studio — the five-year plan, the stars — answered in full glory, twenty minutes, the readings at ceiling, the delight total — and the mile — the boxes, the lease signed in March, the move that has sat unpacked since spring — answered in eight words, waved through, the subject changed, the descent refused — and the skywatcher's key evening star, the one the dome room has waited the whole cosmos to log: the refusal is not evasive. the ephemeris should mark it plainly: the mile bores the stargazer visibly — the readings drop, the eyes lift, the whole instrument powers down between the star and the step — and the guests, the star count's exit interviews converge, cannot sky map it as laziness, because the stargazer works hard — the night shifts, the saved money, the certifications earned — it sky maps it as strangeness: the most energetic person in the room, airborne over a row of unopened boxes — and the check's one measurement, aimed past the flight at the cost underneath: count the deferred miles. the star count ran it across the night surveys: the plans launched, in the pencilled decade — dozens; the stars, kept, raised, delightful — all of them; the miles walked, the first steps actually taken on any plan — and the arithmetic, shadowed honestly, is the field check's whole finding: the stargazer has eleven unopened boxes, an unsigned lease renewal, a passport four years expired, a friendship at two years of unanswered texts — and every one of the deferred items is attainable by lunch — and the party's warmest guest, called upon at the door what the stargazer's year held, delivered the parallax in one sentence, sketched verbatim because it is the cosmos's thesis before the cosmos begins: "Mars, twice. And I don't think he's renewed his driver's license."

Chapter 2: The Core — the Engine of the Far Aim

Every archetype on this observatory runs on a first telescope that worked, and the Stargazing Dreamer's is the only one that looks like a telescope — a small child, in a small life, aiming the whole of the self at one far point until the smallness lost the room. The first comet, assembled from a hundred wonder sky maps: the narrow house, the narrow means, the narrow expectations — people like us don't — and the child who answered it not with endurance, not with rage, not with service, but with aim: looked up, found a star, and made the star the home address. And the aiming worked immediately, which is the founding's whole proof: the small room stopped defining the child, because the child no longer lived in the small room; the child lived in the gap between here and the star, and the gap, the file notes, was roomy — bigger

than the house, bigger than the town, unbounded on the far side, and furnished with the only identity the small life could not pre-assign: the one who will.

So the engine installed itself: the target always slightly beyond the wingspan, the gap treated as fuel rather than rebuke. And the payoff, the two-stroke mechanism the sky map must name precisely, because the adult biography is unintelligible without it.

The first stroke is the rescue. The aim lifted the child over the smallness — over the narrow expectations, over the pre-written life, over the house's whole gravitational field; and the rescue was not a one-time escape but a daily one: every small, suffocating day of the childhood was survivable because it was not the real day; the real day was out there, past the marker buoys, waiting for the one who aimed. The engine's first wage, paid in the only currency a child keeps: identity — the child of the small house became the one with the star, and the title was self-issued, self-kept, and no one could take it away, because no one had to give it.

The second stroke is the fuel — and the file must be careful here, because this is the founding's genuine genius: the gap, which the world reads as failure, is processed by this engine as energy. Too far from the star reads as free room to grow; the gap's honest measurement ("you are here, and it is there") arrives in this constitution as directions rather than rebuke; and the type's relationship to impossibility is the exact inverse of the ordinary: the ordinary child asks "can I?" and shrinks at the answer; this child asked "what if I don't?" — and the answer to that was the small life, already furnished, already lived by everyone around, and the child chose the gap. The founding's deepest sentence, kept verbatim in every case file: aiming too low was the only real failure — because the low aims were already taken, and the high aim, impossible as it was, was at least unclaimed.

And the aperture's secret clause, the one that organizes the whole shadow chapter, was written by the rescue itself: the identity is the aiming, not the arriving — the star was never meant to be caught. Caught, it becomes a shelf item; the gap closes; the title dissolves; and the one who aims is suddenly at the destination, which is a place, with a present in it, and the present is where the smallness lived. So the target moves outward as the reach grows — the promotion aimed past, the success re-aimed higher, the landing converted immediately into a launchpad — and the file's honest arithmetic, held gently: the engine never intended to arrive. The engine intended to escape, daily, forever, and it did its job magnificently — and the life, in the meantime, waited in escrow.

the aperture keeps cloudless books, and the cloudless line is this: the rescue was real — the sky map's respect for the child who aimed their way out of a suffocating room is total, and this book will never once ask the Dreamer to lower the star; the aim is among the most life-giving instruments in this this firmament. The error is not the height; it is the residence: the first comet concluded that the self lives in the gap, and the present declined itself into a waiting room — and the adult discovery the clarifying chapter will engineer is the whole book in one sentence: the aim was never meant to be lived in; it was meant to be walked toward — and the mile, walked, turns out to contain the present, the body, the love, and the small warm life that was never the

enemy, and never was.

The core sky map closes with the exhibit the grown wonders finally surfaced, because the far aim was built under a specific roof, and the star count finally got the interview the cosmos was missing: the witness to the first comet — the smallness that was answered with stars. the wonder: the Dreamer at fifty-two, the aim certified at four decades — and the star count's interview with the stargazer's grandmother: the one who raised the child the summer the smallness was installed. Her account, offered at eighty-one, when the star count read the first comet back to her, and the transcript is sketched in full because the aperture's origin has never before been described by the person who paid for it: "the ephemeris should have those years exactly, because everything hangs off them: his parents were gone by seven — the ephemeris can check the sky map; I raised him from the second grade — and the house he came to was small, and I will say what the sky map must say plainly: the smallness was mine. The little row house, the pension, the neighborhood where everyone worked doubles — and I watched the boy do the thing I am calling the census to record, because it is the founding the whole catalog turns on: he mapped the smallness. Eight years old, and he came home from the other kids' houses — the big ones, the yards — and he stood in my kitchen and measured it with his eyes, and I could see the child's arithmetic running: the gap — between here and there, between us and them, between this kitchen and the houses with the yards — and the star count will want the first comet afternoon, and I'll give it honestly, because I have had fifty years to find the exact truth of it: the telescope. Secondhand, the church sale, three dollars — and I bought it because the boy had asked for a bicycle, and the telescope was what the table had, and I want the record to have my sentence plainly, verbatim, because it is the engine's whole origin and he has carried it as scripture: I handed it across and I said, 'aim past it, baby. This street is too small for you. Put your eye somewhere they can't measure.' And the record should log what the boy did with the telescope, because it is the aim's whole installation: he never once looked down. The roof, every night that summer — Saturn, the rings, the boy's whole face lit by something three thousand miles past the kitchen — and the gap, the one between here and there, stopped being a wound that summer and became fuel — and I paid the lesson, the record should mark this, because the currency was pride: 'aim past it' — and the whole neighborhood heard it — 'ask him about Saturn' — and the boy answered the way the brilliant answer: he aimed past everything. The grades for the school across the country. The plans for the cities on the coasts. The career, the dream, the whole horizon, filed as a to-do list — and the ephemeris should log the aperture's cloudless yield, because the grandmother's ledger must be sketched fairly: the aim, four decades, worked. The scholarships, the flight out, the career that made the coast — the boy outgrew the street, exactly as instructed — and the cost, the one the lesson never priced, which I want sketched from the buyer's chair, because the boy will hear this from no one else: the telescope was meant to lift his eye past the street, not past the sidewalk. That is the parallax, and it took me fifty years to say it: I aimed the child at the stars because the street was too small for him — and I never once said the sentence the smallness also needed: the sidewalk is walkable, baby. The kitchen is here. The dinner is at six, and the dinner is not the enemy of Saturn — and the boy

learned the lesson too well, and the whole grammar became one clause: if it is attainable, it is beneath the eye — the boxes, the leases, the passport, the friendships — three thousand miles of aiming, and not one mile walked, because the mile, the ephemeris should log with its driest care, was the street's size, and the street's size was the wound — and the amendment, which the star count must enter as the first comet's whole sentence: the stars were never the mistake. The stars were the rescue — the only roof a small child could put between himself and the kitchen's arithmetic — and the mistake was the calibration, and it was mine: the aim was supposed to lift the eye past the street, love. It was never supposed to lift the feet — and the mile, the finding the pride never once let itself predict: the mile was never the smallness. The mile was the way out of it, and it has been sitting under the telescope, unopened, for forty years.

Chapter 3: The Instrument — the Aim, Taken Apart

The Stargazing Dreamer's signature tool is the aim itself — the far target, held past the reach — and the world sky maps it under "dreamer," which is true and misses the mechanism almost entirely, because an aim this consistent is not a fantasy; it is an instrument. Take it apart.

The Mechanics

Open the case and three assemblies are found. First, the beyond-the-wingspan calibration: the target sits deliberately past the reach — close enough to see, far enough to require growth, and adjusted outward as the wings grow, a calibration the stargazer performs without ever being taught; the mechanism is the rescue's: the gap must stay a gap, because the gap is the residence. Second, the horizon as to-do list: the far aim broken — at least rhetorically — into its enormous parts, recited like a schedule; the moon mentioned like a suburb, the decade handled like a quarter; the mechanic converts impossible into not yet, which is the founding's core technology and genuinely one of the most valuable reframings in this catalog. Third, the wince-hunger: the Dreamer is energized, not deterred, by the realists' wince — the skepticism is read as evidence of height, the dismissal as proof of distance; the instrument turns the world's doubt into calibration, and the file notes, with respect: this is armor of the highest grade, and every far thing ever built was defended by it.

The Range

The range deserves the cloudless statement, because it is the highest hope range in this firmament. The Dreamer refuses the ceiling — and every person in range gets to watch one human being treat the ceiling as a rumor; the effect on the young, the stuck, and the small-town watchful is documented across every case file: the aim is contagious, the horizon is visible from the type's yard, and more than one biography in this series was started by a Dreamer who aimed out loud. The type normalizes crisis — the impossible target makes ordinary disasters bearable, which is why this

constitution is calm in the storm. And the type opens rooms: the plan three sizes too big, arriving in any meeting, family, or friendship, expands what everyone present believes is allowed — and the file's honest public entry: the visions were frequently wrong, the numbers were frequently absurd, and the expansion was real anyway, and the people in range were larger for it.

The Honest Limits

The sheet continued, with the costs entered as plainly as the credits. It cannot inhabit the present — the today is the gap's waiting room, and the stargazer declines it like a bad job offer: the apartment unfurnished ("we're moving to the real life soon"), the ordinary Tuesday unbeared, the small finished thing unread; the present is where the smallness lives, and the stargazer does not go back there. It cannot honor the attainable — "settling" is the founding's dirty word, and the attainable arrives pre-dismissed: the good job, the good home, the good enough anything — each one evidence of small living, and the file's coldest entry: the Dreamer has declined a decade of good things and called the declining ambition. It cannot land — the arrival, examined honestly, is the identity's end; the promotion re-aimed within the week, the milestone celebrated for a day and converted to a launchpad by morning. And it cannot walk the mile alone — the deepest limit, and the shadow's whole subject: because the aim was built for escaping, the steps were never part of the design; the mile is beneath the instrument's resolution, the stargazer squints past it, and the star stays exactly where it is — the gap beautifully maintained, the wings never actually used. It can aim at anything. It has almost never walked — and the growth chapter is addressed to the legs.

And the instrument sky map closes with the session the dome room has waited the whole cosmos to log, because the aim has never before been read by the eye that owns it — the auxiliary interview, shadowedat the stargazer's own apartment, the telescope on the sill, the boxes still unopened in the hall, with the skywatcher's one clear-sighted instruction: take the aim apart, at rest. The transcript, verbatim, because the instrument's cloudless specification has never before been spoken by its operator: "the star count should mark the terms, because the sky map has earned them: this is the sill — the ephemeris should log the site; the telescope is the instrument's home port, and the boxes, the ephemeris should log them too, because they are the exhibit — and the collimation can open with the engineering plainly: the aim is a one-directional optic. That is the machine's whole design and its cloudless limit: it magnifies the far. The stars, the coast, the five-year plans, the whole horizon resolved in glorious detail at any distance — and the near, the record should mark this with its driest care: invisible. Not blurred — invisible: the optic has no function for the attainable — the boxes, the lease, the passport, the two-year-old texts — each one, run through the instrument, resolves to nothing: no glory, no fuel, no reading — and the fieldworker asked the obvious question — 'then what moves the near?' — and the cloudless answer, the one the stargazer has never said to anyone, because there was no one at this sill: nothing moves the near. The near is carried — by inertia, by other people, by the kind of deadline that arrives with a fine attached — and the ephemeris

should log the spec's cloudless rates, because they are the parallax's floor: forty years of operation; the far, resolved and re-resolved, the plans kept current to the decade; the near, walked, in the same forty years: the renewals done by other hands, the moves managed by partners, the friendships survived by the friends' own mercy — and the stargazer, the whole parallax, has never once, in forty years, walked a mile for the joy of the walking. And the skywatcher called upon the rules of the sky's clear-sighted question — 'what does the aim deliver, at its cloudless best?' — and I'll give the dome room the answer, because the collimation produced it and there's no other cloudless way: escape velocity. The aim, at ceiling, with the best star, delivers the lift — the moment the eye locks the gap stops being a wound and becomes fuel, the kitchen's arithmetic suspended, the readings at ceiling — and the lift is real, the census certifies it: the scholarships were flown on it; the coast was reached on it — and the trap, the spec's whole signature: the lift is the product. Not the arrival — the stargazer has never once, in any sky map, landed: the star reached is retired the moment it becomes attainable, and the instrument re-locks on the next gap — and the ephemeris should log the arithmetic with everything it has: stars reached, in the sky map's history: eleven — the degree, the coast, the career, the marriage, every one of them once a horizon and now a near — and the readings, shadowedon the reached stars: flat. The stars that arrive are invisible by morning — and the optic, aimed outward, forty years, has never once reviewed its own yield. And the collimation's closing test, which the skywatcher set, one session, one optic, the instrument aimed at the near for once: 'resolve the boxes.' And the ephemeris should log what the instrument did, because it is the clarifying chapter arriving inside the spec: it refused. Three times — the eye lifting, the readings dropping, the near waved through — and the fourth, the tape, which the dome room should mark with everything it has: the skywatcher's clear-sighted instruction — do not ask for the plan; ask for the handle — and the stargazer, hand on the first box, the readings rising, and the first mile-entry in the sky map's whole history, delivered through it, verbatim: 'the box has kitchen things in it. I packed it in March — and the ephemeris should log the parallax, because it took one hand on one handle and forty years to find it: the near is not the enemy's terrain. The near is the mile — the actual mile the founding always meant — and the mile, the whole spec's finding, does not kill the star. The mile is the star's sidewalk, and the star, seen from the mile, is closer. The telescope stays. The handle, love, was always the missing lens.

Chapter 4: The Craft — the Practice Years

The world files the Stargazing Dreamer under "dreamer," full stop — the type as a permanent adolescent, all horizon and no mileage. The truth is more complicated and more interesting: the aim was practiced — daily, for decades, in the world's most private classroom — and the practice years are the ephemeris of an escape artist perfecting the escape, with the exit route maintained and the residence never once inspected.

The Apprenticeship

The apprenticeship began at the founding: the small life, the star, and the child's discovery that the aim could be inhabited — and the child did inhabit it, with a discipline the adults mistook for idleness. The training ran on the child's real life: the hours spent in the aim (the star charts, the plans, the traced routes — the residence work, practiced until the gap felt more like home than the house); the library as the property office; the biographies of the far-arrivers read as maps rather than stories — every one mined for the route, and the sky map notes the consistent finding, gently: the child read the arrival chapters and skipped the walking ones, because the walking chapters were about the present, and the present was the thing being escaped. And the curriculum's core course, self-taught and mastered: the calibration — the target kept beyond the reach, adjusted outward as the reach grew; the apprentice learned to recognize the approach of attainability the way a sailor reads a lee shore, and to re-aim before the gap could close, long before anyone could call the closing a landing.

The Repertoire

The adult repertoire is the apprenticeship, hardened into mastery: the vision delivery (the plan three sizes too big, told with a calm that converts rooms — the party skill, the board skill, and the sky map notes it is a real skill: belief, genuinely conveyed, and rare); the crisis-normalizing reach (the disaster reframed as a feature of the route — the calm that steadies crews, priced in the costs chapter, because it also re-frames the ordinary as unbearable by contrast); the wince-conversion (the skeptic's doubt processed into calibration fuel within the hour — the armor, worn so long it has become the stargazer's skin); and the re-aiming reflex (the landing initiated to a launchpad before the dust settles — the escape maintained, the residence preserved, the sky map's cloudless note: this is the whole engine in one reflex, and the stargazer performs it like breathing, and has never once been caught doing it).

The Masters

The masters of this type are pointers rather than teachers — the grandfather with the star charts, the teacher who said "why not you," the author of the one book that opened like a roof; and the master's instruction, across every case file, is the same gesture: up — a direction given once, from the smallness, by someone who meant it. the stargazer learns by aiming, and what the elders passed down was the first comet's complete gift: the permission to look up, the proof that the ceiling was a rumor. And the apprenticeship's deepest debt, the sky map records honestly: the masters taught the aiming and never the walking — because most of them, too, were Dreamers; the grandfather's star charts were thirty years old at his death, the route never taken; the teacher's "why not you" was the whole of a life that had asked itself the same question and never answered it in the first person. The inheritance was magnificent and one page short: the next Dreamer received the telescope, and no instructions for the feet — and the aim's true debt to the master, discovered only in midlife, is this: the most loving thing the pointer ever did was point. The walking was always going to have to be the student's own.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Aiman Sterling is the author of The Archetype Series -- a library of personality portraits drawn the way literature draws characters: the great types of human temperament, recognized at a glance, understood in depth, and followed from childhood wound to mature strength.